

## Benny Marshall says— *Pirate brass echoes Andy on J. C. Powers*



*We could talk about baseball . . .*

IT MUST BE a source of great satisfaction to your old friend Dandy Andrew Cohen, safely away from the shrill and far-carrying voices of the New Orleans wolves, to hear what Pittsburgh Pirate folks now are saying about J. C. Powers.

It's what Andy never stopped saying; not even at the gloomy end of the 1956 season when New Orleans baseball was a fortress tumbling down, and he was standing almost forlornly in the midst of the debris.

Things were so bad at New Orleans, the old Alabama full-back who managed the Pels, might even have lost his trademarked grin . . . if it hadn't been for the savage swing of the boy from Birmingham who played outfield for him.

"He will be a big leaguer," Andy insisted.

"You can't keep that kind of a bat out of the big leagues.

"No, I don't know where he'll play. But he'll play. And he'll hit 'em up there just like he hits 'em down here."

Latest intelligences drifting through from Pirate headquarters (never overly-enchanted with Dale Long, the early hero of '56) is that J. C. is about to be groomed for first base employment with the club that owns him.

They mean it, too. This isn't Hot Stove conversation.

Joe L. Brown, the general manager, is on record recently with such as, "Two of the greatest wrists I've ever seen. . . He can run, throw and field. . . He could have hit 60 home runs at New Orleans if he hadn't been so strong he was pulling the ball foul."

And George Sisler, who taught J. C. where the strike zone was last Spring, will be working on his hitting again.

George has been quoted, "At this stage of his development," I would compare Powers with Duke Snider when he was breaking in."

At 25, J. C. may be ready to make the big jump. . . No one will be happier about it than Cohen, who stuck by him when some other people were ready to give up.

It takes patience, also, to make a big league star.

*Then, there's always football . . .*



**POWERS**